



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

duṣprajñāś cāpare deva jñānavijñānavarjitāḥ | BRP225.043.1
kena karmavipākena prajñāvān puruṣo bhavet || 43 || BRP225.043.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 225: On rebirth (dialogue between Śiva and Umā, cont.) (Chapter 225), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Uma, in her boundless curiosity and devotion to Shiva, poses a fundamental question about the nature of intelligence and wisdom. She observes that some individuals seem to lack true understanding, being devoid of both theoretical knowledge (jñana) and practical wisdom (vijnana). She then asks, "By what karmic fruition does a person become intelligent?" This verse, nestled within a conversation about rebirth, delves into the profound connection between actions and the development of intellect.

The verse highlights a critical distinction. It's not merely about acquiring information; it's about cultivating genuine wisdom. Jñana refers to book learning, the accumulation of facts and figures. Vijnana, on the other hand, is the experiential understanding, the ability to apply knowledge effectively and discern truth from falsehood. The verse implicitly suggests that true intelligence isn't simply a matter of innate ability but is rather the result of accumulated karmas, actions performed over lifetimes that shape our capacity for understanding.

For you, navigating the complexities of modern life, this verse offers a powerful reminder. It encourages you to look beyond superficial achievements and focus on cultivating genuine wisdom. Are you simply accumulating information, or are you actively seeking to understand its deeper meaning and practical application? The Brahmapurana suggests that acts of kindness, selfless service, and ethical conduct contribute to the development of a sharper, more discerning intellect. Every action, thought, and intention leaves an imprint on your consciousness, shaping your capacity for wisdom in future lives. Therefore, choose your actions carefully, with a focus on compassion and integrity, and you will gradually cultivate the intelligence that transcends mere knowledge. Embrace learning, but prioritize understanding and ethical action.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What small, conscious action can you take today to cultivate wisdom (vijnana) beyond mere knowledge (jñana)?